

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent

12386204

Kind Code

B2

Date of Patent

August 12, 2025

Inventor(s)

Legerton; Jerome A. et al.

Systems, apparatus, and methods for regulating refractive error development through the modulation of peripheral distortion

Abstract

In general, one aspect disclosed features a spectacle lens, comprising: a central zone having an optical center corresponding to the visual axis of an eye of a patient; and a peripheral zone peripheral to the central zone and comprising: a first zone having a first thickness, and a second zone having a second thickness, wherein: the second thickness varies from the first thickness, and a distance from the second zone to the optical center of the central zone is selected to generate pincushion distortion or barrel distortion in the eye of the patient.

Inventors: Legerton; Jerome A. (Jupiter Inlet Colony, FL), Liu; Jidong (Shenyang, CN), Liu; Gaozhi (Shenyang, CN)

Applicant: SHENYANG KANGENDE MEDICAL SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY CO., LTD (Liaoning, CN)

Family ID: 82905892

Assignee: Shenyang Kangende Medical Science and Technology Co., Ltd. (Shenyang, CN)

Appl. No.: 18/657667

Filed: May 07, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier

Publication Date

US 20240329431 A1

Oct. 03, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 18217953 20230703 US 12050369 child-doc US 18657667

continuation parent-doc US 17795531 US 11768388 20230926 WO PCT/CN2021/104970

20210707 child-doc US 18217953

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G02C7/08 (20060101); G02C7/02 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G02C7/086 (20130101); G02C7/027 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G02C (7/086); G02C (7/027); G02C (7/022); G02C (7/04); G02C (7/041); G02C (2202/12); G02C (2202/24)

USPC: 351/159.7

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
3195145	12/1964	Tisher et al.	N/A	N/A
3904281	12/1974	Jampolsky	N/A	N/A
4645317	12/1986	Frieder et al.	N/A	N/A
5478824	12/1994	Burns et al.	N/A	N/A
5793467	12/1997	Bailey	N/A	N/A
6027214	12/1999	Graham	N/A	N/A
6170952	12/2000	La Haye et al.	N/A	N/A
6488374	12/2001	Alberts	N/A	N/A
6533418	12/2002	Izumitani et al.	N/A	N/A
6736506	12/2003	Izumitani et al.	N/A	N/A
7036929	12/2005	Harvey	N/A	N/A
10571717	12/2019	Neitz et al.	N/A	N/A
10921612	12/2020	Zhou et al.	N/A	N/A
11061253	12/2020	Back et al.	N/A	N/A
2001/0022649	12/2000	Fukuma et al.	N/A	N/A
2003/0090625	12/2002	Izumitani et al.	N/A	N/A
2004/0085516	12/2003	Fukuma et al.	N/A	N/A
2005/0068489	12/2004	Hall et al.	N/A	N/A
2006/0232743	12/2005	Legerton	N/A	N/A
2014/0293216	12/2013	Muradore	351/159.41	G02C 7/027
2015/0219924	12/2014	Moine	351/159.42	G02C 7/028
2016/0054587	12/2015	Brennan	623/6.11	G02C 7/041
2016/0178934	12/2015	Curley et al.	N/A	N/A
2017/0059885	12/2016	Patel	N/A	N/A
2017/0184875	12/2016	Newman	N/A	N/A
2017/0269379	12/2016	Arieli et al.	N/A	N/A
2017/0276961	12/2016	Wooley	N/A	G02C 7/044
2018/0157065	12/2017	Curley et al.	N/A	N/A
2018/0243082	12/2017	Zheleznyak et al.	N/A	N/A
2019/0033619	12/2018	Neitz et al.	N/A	N/A

2019/0302481	12/2018	Zhou et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0330218	12/2019	Canovas Vidal	N/A	A61F 2/164
2021/0055573	12/2020	Back et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0191155	12/2020	Brennan	N/A	A61F 2/1451
2021/0271111	12/2020	Calvin	N/A	N/A
2022/0329933	12/2021	Zhao	N/A	H04R 1/10

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
2685355	12/2007	CA	N/A
212234798	12/2019	CN	N/A
212466322	12/2020	CN	N/A
2010507833	12/2009	JP	N/A
201120500	12/2010	TW	N/A
201421105	12/2013	TW	N/A

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

PCT International Search Report and Written Opinion mailed Mar. 28, 2022, issued in related International Application No. PCT/CN2021/104970 (8 pages). cited by applicant

Notice of Allowance mailed May 22, 2023, issued in related U.S. Appl. No. 17/795,531 (11 pages). cited by applicant

First Search dated Jul. 13, 2023, issued in related Chinese Application No. 202180008766.2 (2 pages). cited by applicant

Notice of Allowance mailed Apr. 11, 2024, issued in related U.S. Appl. No. 18/217,953 (12 pages). cited by applicant

Primary Examiner: Alexander; William R

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Sheppard Mullin Richter & Hampton LLP

Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/217,953, filed on Jul. 3, 2023, entitled “Systems, Apparatus, and Methods for Regulating Refractive Error Development Through the Modulation of Peripheral Distortion,” which is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/795,531, filed on Jul. 26, 2022, entitled “Systems, Apparatus, and Methods for Regulating Refractive Error Development Through the Modulation of Peripheral Distortion,” which is a national stage application under 35 U.S.C. § 371 of International Application No. PCT/CN2021/104970, filed on Jul. 7, 2021, entitled “Systems, Apparatus, and Methods for Regulating Refractive Error Development Through the Modulation of Peripheral Distortion.” The entire contents of the above-identified applications are incorporated herein by reference.

DESCRIPTION OF RELATED ART

(1) The disclosed technology relates generally to lenses, and more particularly some embodiments relate to lenses and for controlling the progression of or eliminating refractive errors.

SUMMARY

(2) In general, one aspect disclosed features a spectacle lens, comprising: a central zone having an optical center corresponding to the visual axis of an eye of a patient; and a peripheral zone peripheral to the central zone and comprising: a first zone having a first thickness, and a second

zone having a second thickness, wherein: the second thickness varies from the first thickness, and a distance from the second zone to the optical center of the central zone is selected to generate pincushion distortion or barrel distortion in the eye of the patient.

(3) Embodiments of the spectacle lens may include one or more of the following features. In some embodiments, the second zone comprises at least one of: a raised area on an anterior surface of the spectacle lens; a raised area on a posterior surface of the spectacle lens; a depressed area on an anterior surface of the spectacle lens; or a depressed area on a posterior surface of the spectacle lens. In some embodiments, the second thickness is selected to generate peripheral defocus in the eye of the patient. In some embodiments, the central zone includes a conic-section curve configured to generate a spherical aberration in the eye of the patient. In some embodiments, the spherical aberration generated in the eye of the patient is one of a positive, negative or neutral spherical aberration. In some embodiments, the second thickness in the second zone is selected to generate a different peripheral defocus in the eye of the patient in two or more semi-meridians. In some embodiments, the distance of the second zone to the center of the central zone is selected to generate different amounts of pincushion distortion or barrel distortion in the eye of the patient in two or more semi-meridians. In some embodiments, the spectacle lens has a colorant added to the material or surface of the film to alter the spectral transmission of the spectacle lens. In some embodiments, light sources are housed within the spectacle lens or on the surface of the spectacle lens for directing wavelength specific light into the eye of the patient.

(4) In general, one aspect disclosed features a spectacle lens comprising: a central zone having an optical center corresponding to the visual axis of an eye of a patient; and a peripheral zone peripheral to the central zone and comprising: a first zone having a first index of refraction, and a second zone having a second index of refraction, wherein: the second index of refraction varies from the first index of refraction, and a distance from the second zone to the optical center of the central zone is selected to generate pincushion distortion or barrel distortion in the eye of the patient.

(5) In general, one aspect disclosed features a method for defining a spectacle lens to be manufactured for an eye of a patient, comprising: selecting a central zone having an optical center corresponding to the visual axis of an eye of the patient; and selecting a peripheral zone peripheral to the central zone; and selecting, for the peripheral zone: a first zone having a first thickness, and a second zone having a second thickness, wherein: the second thickness varies from the first thickness, and a distance from the second zone to the optical center of the central zone is selected to generate pincushion distortion or barrel distortion in the eye of the patient.

(6) Embodiments of the method may include one or more of the following features. Some embodiments comprise selecting, for the second zone, at least one of: a raised area on an anterior surface of the spectacle lens; a raised area on a posterior surface of the spectacle lens; a depressed area on an anterior surface of the spectacle lens; or a depressed area on a posterior surface of the spectacle lens. Some embodiments comprise selecting the second thickness to generate peripheral defocus in the eye of the patient. Some embodiments comprise selecting, for the central zone, a conic-section curve to generate a spherical aberration in the eye of the patient. In some embodiments, the spherical aberration generated in the eye of the patient is one of a positive, negative or neutral spherical aberration. Some embodiments comprise selecting the second thickness in the second zone to generate a different peripheral defocus in the eye of the patient in two or more semi-meridians. Some embodiments comprise selecting the distance of the second zone to the center of the central zone to generate different amounts of pincushion distortion or barrel distortion in the eye of the patient in two or more semi-meridians.

(7) In general, one aspect disclosed features a method for defining a spectacle lens to be manufactured for an eye of a patient, comprising: selecting a central zone having a center corresponding to a visual axis of the eye of the patient; selecting a peripheral zone peripheral to the central zone; and selecting, for the peripheral zone: a first zone having a first index of refraction,

and a second zone having a second index of refraction, wherein: the second index of refraction varies from the first index of refraction, and a distance from the second zone to the optical center of the central zone is selected to generate pincushion distortion or barrel distortion in the eye of the patient.

(8) Embodiments of the method may include one or more of the following features. Some embodiments comprise selecting, for the central zone, a conic-section curve to generate spherical aberration in the eye of the patient. In some embodiments, the spherical aberration generated in the eye of the patient is one of a positive, negative or neutral spherical aberration.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The present disclosure, in accordance with one or more various embodiments, is described in detail with reference to the following figures. The figures are provided for purposes of illustration only and merely depict typical or example embodiments.

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates the use of a contact lens to introduce pincushion distortion according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates pincushion distortion.

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates the use of a contact lens to introduce barrel distortion according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies.

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates barrel distortion.

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates the use of a contact lens to introduce peripheral hyperopia.

(7) FIG. 6 illustrates the use of a contact lens to introduce peripheral myopia.

(8) FIG. 7 illustrates a section for a contact lens for introducing peripheral myopia according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies, both before and after modification to introduce pincushion distortion.

(9) FIG. 8 illustrates a section for a contact lens for introducing peripheral hyperopia according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies, both before and after modification to introduce pincushion distortion.

(10) FIG. 9 illustrates a section for a contact lens for introducing peripheral myopia according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies, both before and after modification to introduce barrel distortion.

(11) FIG. 10 illustrates a section for a contact lens for introducing peripheral hyperopia according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies, both before and after modification to introduce barrel distortion.

(12) FIG. 11 illustrates a contact lens where the features take an annular form, and may be composed of a material having a different refractive index than the body of the contact lens, according to some embodiments.

(13) FIG. 12 is a flowchart illustrating an overview process for defining a lens to be manufactured for an eye of a patient according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies.

(14) FIG. 13 is a flowchart illustrating an overview process for defining a lens to be manufactured for an eye of a patient according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies.

(15) FIG. 14 illustrates the capture of an image of an eye of a patient and a lens opening in a spectacle frame while the gaze of the patient is held in a straight-ahead line of sight according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies.

(16) FIG. 15 illustrates the identification of the perimeter of a lens edge and lens optical center according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies.

(17) FIG. 16 illustrates application of a film defined according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies to a spectacle lens.

(18) FIG. 17 illustrates a patient wearing the completed spectacles according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies.

(19) FIG. 18 depicts a block diagram of an example computer system in which embodiments described herein may be implemented.

(20) The figures are not exhaustive and do not limit the present disclosure to the precise form disclosed.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(21) Myopia, or nearsightedness, is a condition wherein the axial length of the eye is too long, or the crystalline lens is too strong. As a result, the image of a distant object is brought to a focus in front of the retina such that the image is out of focus when the light strikes the retina. The prevalence of myopia is reaching epidemic proportions globally with an incidence of greater than 25% in the United States and Western Europe to as high as 90% in urban China. The incidence of myopia has been shown to be greater in those persons having a college education. In addition, there is a high correlation between the age of commencing concentrated detailed tasks within arm's length and the prevalence and degree of myopia.

(22) Hyperopia, or farsightedness, is a condition wherein the axial length of the eye is too short, or the crystalline lens is too weak. As a result, the image of a distant object is brought to a focus behind the retina such that the image is out of focus when the light strikes the retina.

(23) Embodiments of the disclosed technology control the progression of myopia and reduce hyperopia using lenses that introduce peripheral distortion. In some embodiments, the lenses may control the progression of myopia by introducing pincushion distortion in the peripheral retina. In some embodiments, the lenses may control the progression of hyperopia or reduce the amount of hyperopia by introducing barrel distortion in the peripheral retina. These embodiments may be combined to introduce pincushion distortion in at least one semi-meridian of the peripheral retina, and to introduce barrel distortion in another semi-meridian of the peripheral retina to control astigmatism in an eye. In some embodiments the amount of pincushion distortion introduced may be different in two or more semi-meridians or the amount of barrel distortion introduced may be different in two or more semi-meridians. Although the disclosed technology is discussed primarily with regard to contact lenses, it should be appreciated that the disclosed lenses may be contact lenses, eyeglass lenses, or a combination thereof.

(24) The disclosed embodiments may be combined with contact lens features intended to rotationally stabilize a contact lens on an eye. For example, the different amounts of distortion in two or more semi-meridians may be held in their intended orientation while in place on the eye by use of the features for rotational stabilization. The features for rotational stabilization may include double slab-off, prism ballast, or asymmetric or symmetric thin and thick zones on the anterior surface of the lens, or the like.

(25) The disclosed embodiments may be combined with other techniques to control the progression of myopia and hyperopia. For example, in some embodiments, the lenses may also introduce peripheral defocus. In some embodiments, the lenses may control the progression of myopia by focusing light in front of the peripheral retina. In some embodiments, the lenses may regulate the amount of hyperopia by focusing light behind the peripheral retina.

(26) The disclosed embodiments may be combined with techniques for vision correction. For example, in some embodiments, a central portion of the lenses may also introduce positive and/or negative spherical aberration. In some embodiments, the lenses may control the progression of myopia by introducing positive spherical aberration and focusing light in front of the peripheral retina while light is focused on the central retina. In some embodiments, the lenses may regulate the amount of hyperopia by introducing negative spherical aberration and focusing light behind the peripheral retina while light is focused on the central retina.

(27) The disclosed embodiments may be combined with other techniques to control the progression of myopia and hyperopia. For example, in some embodiments, the lenses may include wavelength

specific filtering to alter the spectral transmission of the lens. The filtering may be throughout the full lens or may be in a specific region of the lens for the purpose of directing a specific wavelength of light to a pre-determined region of the lens. In some embodiments, the lenses may include filters to transmit short wavelengths in the visible spectrum to regulate myopia. In some embodiments, the lenses may include filters to transmit long wavelengths in the visible spectrum to regulate hyperopia.

(28) The disclosed embodiments may be combined with other techniques to control the progression of myopia and hyperopia. For example, in some embodiments, the lenses may include light sources to direct light into the eye. The light sources may be regulated to control at least one of the wavelengths, direction, duration, and illuminance of the light. In some embodiments, the wavelengths of the light may include short wavelengths of the visible spectrum as well as near visible ultraviolet wavelengths to regulate myopia. In some embodiments the wavelengths may include long wavelengths of the visible spectrum to regulate hyperopia. In some embodiments the wavelengths of light may be selected to be different for different meridians or semi-meridians of the retina or different areas or regions of the retina to regulate astigmatism. In some embodiments, the lens has a colorant added to the material or surface of the film to alter the spectral transmission of the lens.

(29) The disclosed embodiments may be in the form of spectacle lenses or combined with a spectacle frame. In some embodiments light sources may be placed in the spectacle frame to direct light into the eye. The light sources may be regulated to control at least one of the wavelengths, direction, duration, and illuminance of the light. In some embodiments, the wavelength of the light may include short wavelengths of the visible spectrum as well as near visible ultraviolet wavelengths to regulate myopia. In some embodiments the wavelengths may include long wavelengths of the visible spectrum to regulate hyperopia. In some embodiments the wavelengths of light may be selected to be different for different meridians or semi-meridians of the retina or different areas or regions of the retina to regulate astigmatism.

(30) FIG. 1 illustrates the use of a contact lens **100** to introduce pincushion distortion according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies. Pincushion distortion is the distortion of an image such that a straight line appears to be curved convexly toward a point in the image, such as the center of the image, as illustrated in FIG. 2. Referring to FIG. 1, axial emmetropia is illustrated by dotted lines at **102**. Axial emmetropia is the refractive state of an eye in which parallel rays of light entering the eye are focused on the macula **104** of the retina **106**, creating an image that is sharp and in focus. The axial emmetropia may be created by the contact lens **100**, or may be a product of the patient's eye.

(31) In FIG. 1, pincushion distortion is illustrated by broken and solid lines at **108**. According to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies, the pincushion distortion may be introduced by one or more features of the contact lens **100**. The features may include a thickened portion of the contact lens **100**, a thinned portion of the contact lens **100**, a material having a different refractive index than an adjacent portion of the contact lens **100**, or any combination thereof. In the example of FIG. 1, the features include a thickened portion **110** of the contact lens **100**.

(32) The features may form an annulus, introducing pincushion distortion in an annular peripheral region of the retina. The features may form other shapes. The features may introduce different degrees of pincushion distortion in different peripheral portions of the retina.

(33) The degree of pincushion distortion introduced by a feature may be selected by selecting a radial distance of the feature from an optical center of the contact lens **100**. Smaller radial distances may increase the degree of introduced pincushion distortion. The optical center of the contact lens **100** may or may not coincide with a geometric center of the contact lens **100**. In some embodiments, the optical center may be displaced from the geometric center of the contact lens a predetermined distance to align with the visual axis of an eye when the lens is in place. In some embodiments, the optical center may not align with the visual axis of an eye when the lens is in

place.

(34) FIG. 3 illustrates the use of a contact lens **300** to introduce barrel distortion according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies. Barrel distortion is the distortion of an image such that a straight line appears to be curved convexly away from a point in the image, such as the center of the image, as illustrated in FIG. 4. Referring to FIG. 3, axial emmetropia is illustrated by dotted lines at **302**. The axial emmetropia may be created by the contact lens **300**, or may be a product of the patient's eye.

(35) In FIG. 3, barrel distortion is illustrated by broken and solid lines at **308**. According to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies, the barrel distortion may be introduced by one or more features of the contact lens **300**. The features may include a thickened portion of the contact lens **300**, a thinned portion of the contact lens **300**, a material having a different refractive index than an adjacent portion of the contact lens **300**, or any combination thereof. In the example of FIG. 3, the features include a thickened portion **310** of the contact lens **300**.

(36) The features may form an annulus, introducing barrel distortion in an annular peripheral region of the retina. The features may form other shapes. The features may introduce different degrees of barrel distortion in different peripheral portions of the retina.

(37) The degree of barrel distortion introduced by a feature may be selected by selecting a radial distance of the feature from an optical center of the contact lens **100**. Larger radial distances may increase the degree of introduced barrel distortion. The optical center of the contact lens **100** may or may not coincide with a geometric center of the contact lens **100**. In some embodiments, the optical center may be displaced from the geometric center of the contact lens a predetermined distance to align with the visual axis of an eye when the lens is in place. In some embodiments, the optical center may not align with the visual axis of an eye when the lens is in place.

(38) FIG. 5 illustrates the use of a contact lens **500** to introduce peripheral hyperopia. Referring to FIG. 5, axial emmetropia is illustrated by dotted lines at **502**. The axial emmetropia may be created by the contact lens **500**, or may be a product of the patient's eye.

(39) In FIG. 5, peripheral hyperopia is illustrated by solid lines at **508**. According to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies, the peripheral hyperopia may be introduced by one or more features **510** of the contact lens **500**. The features may include a thickened portion of the contact lens **500**, a thinned portion of the contact lens **500**, a material having a different refractive index than an adjacent portion of the contact lens **500**, or any combination thereof. The degree of introduced peripheral hyperopia may be selected by selecting an axial thickness of the feature **510**.

(40) The features may form an annulus, introducing peripheral hyperopia in an annular peripheral region of the retina. The features may form other shapes. The features may introduce different degrees of peripheral hyperopia in different peripheral portions of the retina.

(41) FIG. 6 illustrates the use of a contact lens **600** to introduce peripheral myopia. Referring to FIG. 6, axial emmetropia is illustrated by dotted lines at **602**. The axial emmetropia may be created by the contact lens **600**, or may be a product of the patient's eye.

(42) In FIG. 6, peripheral myopia is illustrated by solid lines at **608**. According to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies, the peripheral myopia may be introduced by one or more features **610** of the contact lens **600**. The features may include a thickened portion of the contact lens **600**, a thinned portion of the contact lens **600**, a material having a different refractive index than an adjacent portion of the contact lens **600**, or any combination thereof. The degree of introduced peripheral myopia may be selected by selecting an axial thickness of the feature **610**.

(43) The features may form an annulus, introducing peripheral myopia in an annular peripheral region of the retina. The features may form other shapes. The features may introduce different degrees of peripheral myopia in different peripheral portions of the retina.

(44) In some embodiments, the features may be arranged to introduce different degrees of peripheral myopia and/or peripheral hyperopia in different peripheral portions of the retina. These embodiments may be designed to regulate astigmatism.

(45) FIG. 7 illustrates a section for a contact lens **700** for introducing peripheral myopia according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies, both before and after modification to introduce pincushion distortion. Referring to FIG. 7, the contact lens **700** includes a feature **702** for introducing peripheral myopia in the form of a region of increased thickness, as depicted by a solid line. The contour of the anterior surface of the feature **702** may be characterized using spline mathematics by three knots k1, k2, and k3. The knot k2 at the apex of the thickness is referred to herein as the “apical knot”. The degree of peripheral myopia introduced by the feature **702** may be selected by selecting the distance of the apical knot k2 from the center of the eye.

(46) Pincushion distortion may be introduced by moving the apical knot k2 toward the optical center of the contact lens **700**, as illustrated by the broken line in FIG. 7. The degree of pincushion distortion introduced may be created by selecting the radial distance from the apical knot k2 to the optical center of the lens **700**, with decreasing radial distances introducing greater degrees of pincushion distortion. Table 1 provides example parameters for an example contact lens **700** according to FIG. 7.

(47) TABLE-US-00001

TABLE 1	Annular	K1	K3	K2	Edge	Central	Spherical	Add	semi	semi	semi
	Power	Aberration	Power	chord	chord	chord	chord	(Diopters)	(microns)	(Diopters)	(mm)
	(mm)	(mm)	(mm)	–1.00	0.15	3.00	1.75	4.75	2.50	7.20	

(48) FIG. 8 illustrates a section for a contact lens **800** for introducing peripheral hyperopia according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies, both before and after modification to introduce pincushion distortion. Referring to FIG. 8, the contact lens **800** includes a feature **802** for introducing peripheral hyperopia in the form of a region of decreased thickness, as depicted by a solid line. The contour of the anterior surface of the feature **802** may be characterized using spline mathematics by three knots k1, k2, and k3. The degree of peripheral hyperopia introduced by the feature **802** may be selected by selecting the distance of the apical knot k2 from the center of the eye.

(49) Pincushion distortion may be introduced by moving the apical knot k2 away from the optical center of the contact lens **800**, as illustrated by the broken line in FIG. 8. The degree of pincushion distortion introduced may be created by selecting the radial distance from the apical knot k2 to the optical center of the lens **800**, with increasing radial distances introducing greater degrees of pincushion distortion.

(50) FIG. 9 illustrates a section for a contact lens **900** for introducing peripheral myopia according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies, both before and after modification to introduce barrel distortion. Referring to FIG. 9, the contact lens **900** includes a feature **902** for introducing peripheral myopia in the form of a region of increased thickness, as depicted by a solid line. The contour of the anterior surface of the feature **902** may be characterized using spline mathematics by three knots k1, k2, and k3. The degree of peripheral myopia introduced by the feature **902** may be selected by selecting the distance of the apical knot k2 from the center of the eye.

(51) Barrel distortion may be introduced by moving the apical knot k2 away from the optical center of the contact lens **900**, as illustrated by the broken line in FIG. 9. The degree of barrel distortion introduced may be selected by selecting the radial distance from the apical knot k2 to the optical center of the lens **900**, with increasing radial distances introducing greater degrees of barrel distortion.

(52) FIG. 10 illustrates a section for a contact lens **1000** for introducing peripheral hyperopia according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies, both before and after modification to introduce barrel distortion. Referring to FIG. 10, the contact lens **1000** includes a feature **1002** for introducing peripheral hyperopia in the form of a region of reduced thickness, as depicted by a solid line. The contour of the anterior surface of the feature **1002** may be characterized using spline mathematics by three knots k1, k2, and k3. The degree of peripheral hyperopia introduced by the feature **1002** may be selected by selecting the distance of the apical knot k2 from the center of the eye.

(53) Barrel distortion may be introduced by moving the apical knot k2 toward the optical center of the contact lens **1000**, as illustrated by the broken line in FIG. **10**. The degree of barrel distortion introduced may be selected by selecting the radial distance from the apical knot k2 to the optical center of the lens **1000**, with decreasing radial distances introducing greater degrees of barrel distortion. Table 2 provides example parameters for an example contact lens **1000** according to FIG. **10**.

(54) TABLE-US-00002

TABLE 2	Annular	K1	K3	K2	Edge	Central	Spherical	Add	semi	semi	semi
Power	Aberration	Power	chord	chord	chord	chord	(Diopters)	(microns)	(Diopters)	(mm)	(mm)
3.00	-0.15	-3.00	1.75	4.75	2.50	7.20					

(55) In the examples of FIGS. **7-10**, the described features may be deployed on the anterior surface of the contact lens, on the posterior surface of the contact lens, or both.

(56) As noted above, the features may take an annular form, and may be composed of a material having a different refractive index than the body of the contact lens. FIG. **11** illustrates a contact lens **1100** according to one such embodiment. Referring to FIG. **11**, the contact lens **1100** includes a peripheral zone **1102** and a central zone **1108** having an optical center **1104**. The peripheral zone includes a first zone **1102a** and a second zone **1102b**. An annular feature **1106** within the second zone **1102b** may have a different refractive index than that of the first zone **1102a**. The radial distance of the annular feature **1106** from the optical center **1104** may be selected to introduce selected degrees of pincushion distortion and barrel distortion. Cross-sectional shapes of the annular feature **1106** may also be selected to introduce selected degrees of pincushion distortion and barrel distortion. The cross-sectional shapes may be biconvex, single convex, biconcave, single concave or meniscus.

(57) FIG. **12** is a flowchart illustrating an overview process **1200** for defining a lens to be manufactured for an eye of a patient according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies. One or more parts of the process **1200** may be performed by a computer. The computer may be implemented, for example, as describe below with reference to FIG. **14**. Again, although the disclosed technology is discussed primarily with regard to contact lenses, it should be appreciated that the disclosed lenses may be contact lenses, eyeglass lenses, or a combination thereof.

(58) The elements of the process **1200** are presented in one arrangement. However, it should be understood that one or more elements of the process may be performed in a different order, in parallel, omitted entirely, and the like. Furthermore, the process **1200** may include other elements in addition to those presented.

(59) Referring to FIG. **12**, the process **1200** may include selecting a central zone having a center corresponding to visual axis of an eye of the patient, at **1202**. In the example of FIG. **11**, the central zone **1108** may be selected.

(60) Referring again to FIG. **12**, the process **1200** may include selecting a peripheral zone peripheral to the central zone, at **1204**. In the example of FIG. **11**, the peripheral zone **1102** may be selected.

(61) Referring again to FIG. **12**, the process **1200** may include selecting, for the peripheral zone, a first zone having a first thickness, at **1206**. In the example of FIG. **11**, the first zone **1102a** may be selected.

(62) Referring again to FIG. **12**, the process **1200** may include selecting, for the peripheral zone, a second zone having a second thickness, wherein the second thickness varies from the first thickness, and a distance from the second zone to the center of the central zone is selected to generate pincushion distortion or barrel distortion in the eye of the patient, at **1208**. In the example of FIG. **11**, the second zone **1102b** may be selected.

(63) FIG. **13** is a flowchart illustrating an overview process **1300** for defining a lens to be manufactured for an eye of a patient according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies. One or more parts of the process **1300** may be performed by a computer. The computer may be implemented, for example, as describe below with reference to FIG. **14**. Again, although the

disclosed technology is discussed primarily with regard to contact lenses, it should be appreciated that the disclosed lenses may be contact lenses, eyeglass lenses, or a combination thereof.

(64) The elements of the process **1300** are presented in one arrangement. However, it should be understood that one or more elements of the process may be performed in a different order, in parallel, omitted entirely, and the like. Furthermore, the process **1300** may include other elements in addition to those presented.

(65) Referring to FIG. **13**, the process **1300** may include selecting a central zone having a center corresponding to a visual axis of the eye of the patient, at **1302**. An example of FIG. **11**, the central zone **1104** may be selected.

(66) Referring again to FIG. **13**, the process **1300** may include selecting a peripheral zone peripheral to the central zone, at **1304**. In the example of FIG. **11**, the peripheral zone **1102** may be selected.

(67) Referring to FIG. **13**, the process **1300** may include selecting, for the peripheral zone, a first zone having a first index of refraction, at **1306**. An example of FIG. **11**, the first zone **1102a** may be selected.

(68) Referring to FIG. **13**, the process **1300** may include selecting, for the peripheral zone, a second zone having a second index of refraction, wherein the second index of refraction varies from the first index of refraction, and a distance from the second zone to the center of the central zone is selected to generate pincushion distortion or barrel distortion in the eye of the patient, at **1308**. In the example of FIG. **11**, the second zone **1102b** may be selected.

(69) The disclosed lenses may be fabricated in any manner. For example, the lenses may be fabricated as molded soft contact lenses. The lenses may be made just in time by mold selection or rapid mold making. The lenses may be an inventory product that is picked and shipped to an order. The lenses may be made from using a cutting file method where each lens is custom manufactured by diamond turning. The lenses may be made by material removal with lasers or other means. The lenses may be made by material addition by 3D printing or other means.

(70) The material addition may be in the form of a flexible lens or film having the optical distortion features, where the film may be added to a pre-fabricated spectacle lens. In some embodiments the film may be applied to any spectacle lens to produce the optical distortions described herein. The film may also include at least one of spherical aberration correction in the central zone, peripheral defocus optical elements, wavelength specific filters, or light sources in the peripheral zone in addition to the optical distortion of the present invention. In some embodiments, the flexible lens element has a colorant added to the material or surface of the film to alter the spectral transmission of the flexible lens element. In some embodiments the film may be injection molded of aliphatic thermoplastic polyurethane or materials having similar elastomeric properties. Other materials and means of manufacturing may be used.

(71) The film may be measured and then applied to a pre-fabricated spectacle lens. A spectacle frame with or without such a pre-fabricated spectacle lens may be positioned on the face of the patient. An image of the lens opening in the frame and the eye may be captured while the gaze of the patient is held in a straight-ahead line of sight. FIG. **14** illustrates the capture of such an image according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies. Referring to FIG. **14**, a camera **1402** captures an image of an eye and a lens opening in a spectacle frame **1406** while the gaze of the patient is held in a straight-ahead line of sight. The visual axis may be identified in the image as the center of the pupil or about 5 degrees nasal to the center of the pupil. The perimeter of the lens edge may be identified in the image. The camera may obtain images of the patient wearing the spectacle frame, where the image including a lens opening of the spectacle frame and a corresponding eye of the patient. The perimeter of the lens opening of the spectacle frame may be determined based on the image. An optical center within the lens opening of the spectacle frame may be determined based on the location of the pupil of the eye in the image.

(72) Controlling a cutting system to cut a flexible lens element according to the determined

perimeter of the lens opening and the determined optical center within the lens opening to prepare the flexible lens element for application to a spectacle lens for the spectacle frame

(73) The film containing the optical distortion feature, along with any other of the disclosed elements, may be placed on a stage, placing the optical center of the central zone of the film at a reference location. The film may include orientation marks that represent the angular orientation of meridional or semi-meridional variances in at least one of central power, spherical aberration, peripheral defocus, or the disclosed optical distortion features. The film having the orientation marks may be placed on the stage respective to the angle of the meridian of the meridional or semi-meridional variance feature by way of an angular protractor image on the stage or the like.

(74) A cutting system, for example such as a computer numerically controlled system, may cut the perimeter of the film to the size and shape of the perimeter of the lens. For example, a computer system may control a cutting system to cut the flexible lens element according to the determined perimeter of the lens opening and the determined optical center within the lens opening to prepare the flexible lens element for application to a spectacle lens for the spectacle frame. FIG. 15

illustrates a precut film **1500** according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies.

Referring to FIG. 15, the perimeter of the spectacle lens edge is indicated at **1502**, and an optical distortion feature is indicated at **1504**. The film may be pressed onto the surface of the spectacle lens while matching the perimeter of the film to the perimeter of the spectacle lens. FIG. 16

illustrates application of a film defined according to some embodiments of the disclosed technologies to a spectacle lens. Referring to FIG. 16, a spectacle lens **1602** and film **1604** are shown in cross-section. Also shown is an optical distortion feature **1606** of the film **1604**. The system and method may produce a spectacle lens and film combination with the optical center of the central zone at the location of the visual axis of the patient when the frame with the spectacle lens and film with the optical distortion feature with or without other elements is positioned on the face. Example techniques for applying such a film to a spectacle lens are described in U.S. Pat. Nos. 7,934,831 and 6,170,952. FIG. 17 illustrates a patient wearing the completed spectacles, with an optical distortion feature indicated at **1702**.

(75) Fabrication of the lenses may include changing the index of refraction of a material in a region to change the power of the lens by exposure with a certain wavelength of electromagnetic radiation. The power may be changed by directing the radiation to a zone of the lens that is made of material capable of changing in index of refraction when exposed to a predetermined wavelength of electromagnetic radiation. The index may be changed to produce a desired peripheral defocus and peripheral distortion pattern.

(76) Some or all of the techniques disclosed for the lenses may be employed with the disclosed films. As one example, the processes of FIGS. 12 and 13 may be employed to define the films.

(77) FIG. 18 depicts a block diagram of an example computer system **1800** in which embodiments described herein may be implemented. The computer system **1800** includes a bus **1802** or other communication mechanism for communicating information, one or more hardware processors **1804** coupled with bus **1802** for processing information. Hardware processor(s) **1804** may be, for example, one or more general purpose microprocessors.

(78) The computer system **1800** also includes a main memory **1806**, such as a random access memory (RAM), cache and/or other dynamic storage devices, coupled to bus **1802** for storing information and instructions to be executed by processor **1804**. Main memory **1806** also may be used for storing temporary variables or other intermediate information during execution of instructions to be executed by processor **1804**. Such instructions, when stored in storage media accessible to processor **1804**, render computer system **1800** into a special-purpose machine that is customized to perform the operations specified in the instructions.

(79) The computer system **1800** further includes a read only memory (ROM) **1808** or other static storage device coupled to bus **1802** for storing static information and instructions for processor **1804**. A storage device **1810**, such as a magnetic disk, optical disk, or USB thumb drive (Flash

drive), etc., is provided and coupled to bus **1802** for storing information and instructions.

(80) The computer system **1800** may be coupled via bus **1802** to a display **1812**, such as a liquid crystal display (LCD) (or touch screen), for displaying information to a computer user. An input device **1814**, including alphanumeric and other keys, is coupled to bus **1802** for communicating information and command selections to processor **1804**. Another type of user input device is cursor control **1816**, such as a mouse, a trackball, or cursor direction keys for communicating direction information and command selections to processor **1804** and for controlling cursor movement on display **1812**. In some embodiments, the same direction information and command selections as cursor control may be implemented via receiving touches on a touch screen without a cursor.

(81) The computing system **1800** may include a user interface module to implement a GUI that may be stored in a mass storage device as executable software codes that are executed by the computing device(s). This and other modules may include, by way of example, components, such as software components, object-oriented software components, class components and task components, processes, functions, attributes, procedures, subroutines, segments of program code, drivers, firmware, microcode, circuitry, data, databases, data structures, tables, arrays, and variables.

(82) In general, the word “component,” “engine,” “system,” “database,” data store,” and the like, as used herein, can refer to logic embodied in hardware or firmware, or to a collection of software instructions, possibly having entry and exit points, written in a programming language, such as, for example, Java, C or C++. A software component may be compiled and linked into an executable program, installed in a dynamic link library, or may be written in an interpreted programming language such as, for example, BASIC, Perl, or Python. It will be appreciated that software components may be callable from other components or from themselves, and/or may be invoked in response to detected events or interrupts. Software components configured for execution on computing devices may be provided on a computer readable medium, such as a compact disc, digital video disc, flash drive, magnetic disc, or any other tangible medium, or as a digital download (and may be originally stored in a compressed or installable format that requires installation, decompression or decryption prior to execution). Such software code may be stored, partially or fully, on a memory device of the executing computing device, for execution by the computing device. Software instructions may be embedded in firmware, such as an EPROM. It will be further appreciated that hardware components may be comprised of connected logic units, such as gates and flip-flops, and/or may be comprised of programmable units, such as programmable gate arrays or processors.

(83) The computer system **1800** may implement the techniques described herein using customized hard-wired logic, one or more ASICs or FPGAs, firmware and/or program logic which in combination with the computer system causes or programs computer system **1800** to be a special-purpose machine. According to one embodiment, the techniques herein are performed by computer system **1800** in response to processor(s) **1804** executing one or more sequences of one or more instructions contained in main memory **1806**. Such instructions may be read into main memory **1806** from another storage medium, such as storage device **1810**. Execution of the sequences of instructions contained in main memory **1806** causes processor(s) **1804** to perform the process steps described herein. In alternative embodiments, hard-wired circuitry may be used in place of or in combination with software instructions.

(84) The term “non-transitory media,” and similar terms, as used herein refers to any media that store data and/or instructions that cause a machine to operate in a specific fashion. Such non-transitory media may comprise non-volatile media and/or volatile media. Non-volatile media includes, for example, optical or magnetic disks, such as storage device **1810**. Volatile media includes dynamic memory, such as main memory **1806**. Common forms of non-transitory media include, for example, a floppy disk, a flexible disk, hard disk, solid state drive, magnetic tape, or any other magnetic data storage medium, a CD-ROM, any other optical data storage medium, any

physical medium with patterns of holes, a RAM, a PROM, and EPROM, a FLASH-EPROM, NVRAM, any other memory chip or cartridge, and networked versions of the same.

(85) Non-transitory media is distinct from but may be used in conjunction with transmission media. Transmission media participates in transferring information between non-transitory media. For example, transmission media includes coaxial cables, copper wire and fiber optics, including the wires that comprise bus **1802**. Transmission media can also take the form of acoustic or light waves, such as those generated during radio-wave and infra-red data communications.

(86) The computer system **1800** also includes a communication interface **1818** coupled to bus **1802**. Network interface **1818** provides a two-way data communication coupling to one or more network links that are connected to one or more local networks. For example, communication interface **1818** may be an integrated services digital network (ISDN) card, cable modem, satellite modem, or a modem to provide a data communication connection to a corresponding type of telephone line. As another example, network interface **1818** may be a local area network (LAN) card to provide a data communication connection to a compatible LAN (or a WAN component to communicate with a WAN). Wireless links may also be implemented. In any such implementation, network interface **1818** sends and receives electrical, electromagnetic or optical signals that carry digital data streams representing various types of information.

(87) A network link typically provides data communication through one or more networks to other data devices. For example, a network link may provide a connection through local network to a host computer or to data equipment operated by an Internet Service Provider (ISP). The ISP in turn provides data communication services through the world wide packet data communication network now commonly referred to as the “Internet.” Local network and Internet both use electrical, electromagnetic or optical signals that carry digital data streams. The signals through the various networks and the signals on network link and through communication interface **1818**, which carry the digital data to and from computer system **1800**, are example forms of transmission media.

(88) The computer system **1800** can send messages and receive data, including program code, through the network(s), network link and communication interface **1818**. In the Internet example, a server might transmit a requested code for an application program through the Internet, the ISP, the local network and the communication interface **1818**.

(89) The received code may be executed by processor **1804** as it is received, and/or stored in storage device **1810**, or other non-volatile storage for later execution.

(90) Each of the processes, methods, and algorithms described in the preceding sections may be embodied in, and fully or partially automated by, code components executed by one or more computer systems or computer processors comprising computer hardware. The one or more computer systems or computer processors may also operate to support performance of the relevant operations in a “cloud computing” environment or as a “software as a service” (Saas). The processes and algorithms may be implemented partially or wholly in application-specific circuitry. The various features and processes described above may be used independently of one another, or may be combined in various ways. Different combinations and sub-combinations are intended to fall within the scope of this disclosure, and certain method or process blocks may be omitted in some implementations. The methods and processes described herein are also not limited to any particular sequence, and the blocks or states relating thereto can be performed in other sequences that are appropriate, or may be performed in parallel, or in some other manner. Blocks or states may be added to or removed from the disclosed example embodiments. The performance of certain of the operations or processes may be distributed among computer systems or computers processors, not only residing within a single machine, but deployed across a number of machines.

(91) As used herein, a circuit might be implemented utilizing any form of hardware, or a combination of hardware and software. For example, one or more processors, controllers, ASICs, PLAS, PALs, CPLDs, FPGAs, logical components, software routines or other mechanisms might be implemented to make up a circuit. In implementation, the various circuits described herein

might be implemented as discrete circuits or the functions and features described can be shared in part or in total among one or more circuits. Even though various features or elements of functionality may be individually described or claimed as separate circuits, these features and functionality can be shared among one or more common circuits, and such description shall not require or imply that separate circuits are required to implement such features or functionality. Where a circuit is implemented in whole or in part using software, such software can be implemented to operate with a computing or processing system capable of carrying out the functionality described with respect thereto, such as computer system **1800**.

(92) As used herein, the term “or” may be construed in either an inclusive or exclusive sense. Moreover, the description of resources, operations, or structures in the singular shall not be read to exclude the plural. Conditional language, such as, among others, “can,” “could,” “might,” or “may,” unless specifically stated otherwise, or otherwise understood within the context as used, is generally intended to convey that certain embodiments include, while other embodiments do not include, certain features, elements and/or steps.

(93) Terms and phrases used in this document, and variations thereof, unless otherwise expressly stated, should be construed as open ended as opposed to limiting. Adjectives such as “conventional,” “traditional,” “normal,” “standard,” “known,” and terms of similar meaning should not be construed as limiting the item described to a given time period or to an item available as of a given time, but instead should be read to encompass conventional, traditional, normal, or standard technologies that may be available or known now or at any time in the future. The presence of broadening words and phrases such as “one or more,” “at least,” “but not limited to” or other like phrases in some instances shall not be read to mean that the narrower case is intended or required in instances where such broadening phrases may be absent.

Claims

1. A spectacle lens, comprising: a central zone having an optical center corresponding to the visual axis of an eye of a patient; and a peripheral zone peripheral to the central zone and comprising: a first zone having a first thickness, and a second zone having a second thickness, wherein: the second thickness varies from the first thickness, and a distance from the second zone to the optical center of the central zone is selected to generate pincushion distortion or barrel distortion in the eye of the patient.
2. The spectacle lens of claim 1, wherein the second zone comprises at least one of: a raised area on an anterior surface of the spectacle lens; a raised area on a posterior surface of the spectacle lens; a depressed area on an anterior surface of the spectacle lens; or a depressed area on a posterior surface of the spectacle lens.
3. The spectacle lens of claim 1, wherein: the second thickness is selected to generate peripheral defocus in the eye of the patient.
4. The spectacle lens of claim 1, wherein: the central zone includes a conic-section curve configured to generate a spherical aberration in the eye of the patient.
5. The spectacle lens of claim 4, wherein: the spherical aberration generated in the eye of the patient is one of a positive, negative or neutral spherical aberration.
6. The spectacle lens of claim 1, wherein: the second thickness in the second zone is selected to generate a different peripheral defocus in the eye of the patient in two or more semi-meridians.
7. The spectacle lens of claim 1, wherein: the distance of the second zone to the center of the central zone is selected to generate different amounts of pincushion distortion or barrel distortion in the eye of the patient in two or more semi-meridians.
8. The spectacle lens of claim 1, wherein: the spectacle lens has a colorant added to the material or surface of the film to alter the spectral transmission of the spectacle lens.
9. The spectacle lens of claim 1, wherein: light sources are housed within the spectacle lens or on

the surface of the spectacle lens for directing wavelength specific light into the eye of the patient.

10. A method for defining a spectacle lens to be manufactured for an eye of a patient, comprising: selecting a central zone having an optical center corresponding to the visual axis of an eye of the patient; and selecting a peripheral zone peripheral to the central zone; and selecting, for the peripheral zone: a first zone having a first thickness, and a second zone having a second thickness, wherein: the second thickness varies from the first thickness, and a distance from the second zone to the optical center of the central zone is selected to generate pincushion distortion or barrel distortion in the eye of the patient.

11. The method of claim 10, further comprising: selecting, for the second zone, at least one of: a raised area on an anterior surface of the spectacle lens; a raised area on a posterior surface of the spectacle lens; a depressed area on an anterior surface of the spectacle lens; or a depressed area on a posterior surface of the spectacle lens.

12. The method of claim 10, further comprising: selecting the second thickness to generate peripheral defocus in the eye of the patient.

13. The method of claim 10, further comprising: selecting, for the central zone, a conic-section curve to generate a spherical aberration in the eye of the patient.

14. The method of claim 13, wherein: the spherical aberration generated in the eye of the patient is one of a positive, negative or neutral spherical aberration.

15. The method of claim 10, further comprising: selecting the second thickness in the second zone to generate a different peripheral defocus in the eye of the patient in two or more semi-meridians.

16. The method of claim 10, further comprising: selecting the distance of the second zone to the center of the central zone to generate different amounts of pincushion distortion or barrel distortion in the eye of the patient in two or more semi-meridians.
